

Diego Leyton

Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist

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Senior Software Engineer and Creative Technologist with 14+ years of experience building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, and consumer applications**. I specialize in turning ambitious ideas into polished experiences by combining strong engineering, product thinking, and creativity.

At **Meta**, I served as an **Engineering Manager and Technical Lead** on Horizon Worlds, building large-scale social and multiplayer VR experiences. I am also the **founder of MarMilo**, a Unity-based family application that I have taken from concept to betavalidation with real users.

CAREER SUMMARY

- **14+ years of experience** building interactive products across **games, AR/VR, education, and consumer applications**.
- **7 years at Meta (Facebook)**, serving as **Engineering Manager and Tech Lead** on Horizon Worlds, delivering **large-scale multiplayer VR experiences**.
- Previously **Lead Engineer at Meta Company (AR startup)**, developing **Augmented Reality collaboration technology**, following **5 years in the game industry** (DeNA, Atakama Labs) shipping mobile games worldwide on Google Play, the App Store, and Amazon Appstore.
- **5 years in the game industry** (DeNA, Atakama Labs), leading the development of mobile games released worldwide on Google Play, App Store and Amazon Store.
- **Founder of MarMilo**, leading **product strategy, UX, software engineering, and user research** for a Unity-based platform that helps families build positive habits through **positive reinforcement**.

IMPACT SUMMARY

Product Development

Built products used by millions of users, including Meta's Horizon Worlds and multiple mobile games.

Architecture Design

Created the MVCB architecture pattern, adopted across multiple AR projects.

Engineering Excellence

Led large-scale engineering initiatives at Meta, including architecture and UI migrations, as well as a cross-team quality initiative spanning **9 teams (~90 engineers)** that increased automated test coverage **from 50% to 90%**.

Education

Founded MarMilo, a Unity-based family platform inspired by our own parenting journey, now helping early beta families build positive habits through encouragement, meaningful incentives, and everyday routines.

AR Innovation

Invented a patented smartphone-to-AR interaction technique, helping secure investor funding and earning the **AWE 2017 Best Presentation Award**.

EXPERIENCE

MarMilo

Founder and creator of [MarMilo](#).

Founder & Software Engineer

May 2026 — Present

MarMilo · CA, USA

- Built a cross-platform family habit-building application in Unity, including separate Parents and Kids experiences.
- Designed and implemented a configurable reward system that adapts to each child's developmental needs.
- Developed the complete application architecture, cloud synchronization, content pipeline, and deployment process.
- Conducted beta validation with real families, collecting product feedback and iterating on UX and engagement.
- Led product vision, UX design, engineering, and release planning as a solo founder.

Meta (Facebook)

Tech Lead / Engineering Manager in [Horizon Worlds](#).

Senior Software Engineer & Tech Lead (Horizon Worlds)

Aug 2023 — Mar 2026

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Led performance tools team** to enable creators to evaluate and improve runtime efficiency across Horizon platforms.
- **Led a pillar-wide test coverage initiative across 9 teams (~90 engineers)**, increasing automated test coverage from 50% to 90%, resulting in a measurable reduction in regressions and higher release stability.

Engineering Manager (Horizon Worlds Creation Tools)

Jan 2021 — Aug 2023

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Managed Horizon Worlds team (10+ engineers)**, providing [Creation Tools](#) to users so they can build and share their immersive experiences.
- **Led the migration of Horizon Worlds CreationTools architecture**, enabling faster iteration and better creator experiences.

Senior Software Engineer / Tech Lead

Dec 2018 — Jan 2021

Meta (Facebook) · Menlo Park, CA, USA

- **Tech Lead** of the team building the **Creation Tools** of Horizon Worlds
- **Tech Lead building the VR UI library** for Horizon Worlds.
- Senior Software Engineer **building the first version of Horizon Worlds**.

Meta Company (AR)

Lead Engineer (Augmented Reality)

Dec 2016 — Sep 2018

Meta Company (AR) · San Mateo, CA, USA

- **Led Collaboration in Augmented Reality:** With this feature, users can simultaneously interact with holograms in the AR workspace.
- **Created the org widely used architecture pattern MVCB** based on MVC, to work with different game and graphical engines.
- **Meta Cloud Infrastructure (GoLang):** Worked as a backend and frontend software engineer developing the Meta Cloud infrastructure and micro-services.
- **Inventor of the interaction with Smart Phones in Augmented Reality.** This is an intuitive way to grab content from a Smart Phone, just using the hands (patented). Videos: [Collaboration in AR](#) and [Importing 3D Models](#).
- **Winner of the best presentation for Augmented Reality Award** in AWE 2017, the largest AR+VR event in the world.
- **Managed the architecture improvement** of the Meta2 Workspace, a working environment for Augmented Reality.
- Part of the **SDK team**, implementing features as the calibration profile system for the Meta2 headset.

DeNA Studios

Worked developing **video games as a Technical Lead Engineer.**

Technical Lead Engineer

Jun 2015 — Dec 2016

DeNA Studios San Francisco · San Francisco, CA, USA

- **Technical Lead Engineer of [Deck Storm](#) (Unity 3D).** This is a modern mobile game based on customizable collectible card game (CCCG), and released in Google Play and Apple AppStore.
- **Proposed and successfully implemented engineering quality standards**, reducing the amount of issues found by QA, and improving our game quality, robustness and user experience.

Senior Software Engineer

Feb 2014 — Jun 2015

DeNA Studios Canada · Vancouver, BC, Canada

- **Designed the software architecture** used in most company games.
- Worked on [World of Thingies](#) (Unity3D). This mobile video game was released in Google Play, Apple AppStore and Amazon AppStore.

Software Engineer → Lead Engineer → Project Manager

Jun 2011 — Feb 2014

Atakama Labs (DeNA Studios Santiago) · Santiago, Chile

- **Led [Dungeons and Dragons Arena of War](#) (Unity 3D) and [Galaxy Assault](#) (JavaScript),** games released on Google Play and App Store.
- **Evangelized Unity 3D** adoption across teams through mentorship and training.
- Collaborated with DeNA San Francisco to enhance the company's internal framework (C++, Objective-C, Java, JS).
- Contributed to the Android port of [Zombie Farm](#) using the internal engine; **this title was a key factor in DeNA's acquisition of the company.**

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Educational Applications

Designed and developed multiple interactive learning applications used daily by my children to acquire core cognitive skills.

- [Math Learning App](#) enabling toddlers to understand additions through visual interactions.
- [Brushing Teeth App](#) using interactive virtual pets and rewards to guide children through proper hygiene routines.

Interactive Experiences

- [Horizon Worlds Creation Tools & Scripting Tutorial](#) for the community, which was well received and featured as a must-see resource for beginners.
- [Haunted House](#) giving users a VR experience using Horizon Worlds.

SKILLS

Tech

- C#
- Unity 3D
- C++
- Java
- JavaScript
- React

Methods & Leadership

- Team Management
- Front End
- Agile Methodologies

Domains

- Augmented Reality
- Virtual Reality
- Game Development
- Educational Technologies

Quality & Tools

- Software Usability
- Git
- Phabricator

EDUCATION

Master’s Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2010 — 2013
Engineers’ Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2008 — 2013
Bachelor’s Degree, Computer Science University of Chile	2005 — 2008
Outstanding Student, Computer Science University of Chile	2009 — 2009

PUBLICATIONS

- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "EBTAM: technology acceptance in e-Business environments", Information Systems and e-Business Management, 01 May. 2015.
DOI: 10.1007/s10257-014-0255-2
- Leyton, D.; Pino, J.A.; Ochoa, S.F., "Modeling Technology Acceptance in E-Business Environments", e-Business Engineering (ICEBE), 2013 IEEE 10th International Conference on Coventry, UK, pp.90, 97, 11-13 Sept. 2013.
DOI: 10.1109/ICEBE.2013.14

LANGUAGES

- English — Fluent (written and spoken)
- Spanish — Native